

TOPIC 5: WASTE AND ITS MANAGEMENT

1. Meaning and Types of Waste

Waste is any material that is discarded because it is no longer useful. Types: **biodegradable** (can be broken down by organisms – food scraps, paper, leaves) and **non-biodegradable** (plastics, glass, metals that persist for a long time). Waste can also be classified as solid, liquid or gaseous; domestic, industrial or agricultural.

2. Waste Disposal Methods

Landfill, incineration (burning), composting (for organic waste), dumping in water (harmful and often illegal). Proper methods reduce health and environmental risks.

3. The 3Rs – Reduce, Reuse, Recycle

- **Reduce** – use less; avoid unnecessary packaging.
- **Reuse** – use items again (bottles, bags, containers).
- **Recycle** – process materials to make new products (paper, plastic, metal, glass).

4. Effects of Poor Waste Management

Disease (from dumps and blocked drains), flooding, pollution of soil and water, ugly environment, harm to animals that eat or get trapped in plastic.

5. Summary

Managing waste through the 3Rs and proper disposal protects health and the environment. Everyone can contribute.

End of Topic 5